

RE025 – Google Play Release and Access Checklist

1. Overview

The purpose of this research was to investigate the requirements that need to be considered before the Food Remedy Android application can progress from development and testing towards a Google Play release.

The research focused on Google Play account requirements, application ownership, testing tracks, Android target API requirements, privacy and Data Safety, account deletion, health-related declarations, and other requirements that may delay or prevent release. The main outcome of this research was a practical Google Play release checklist that can be used by the Food Remedy project team to verify release readiness.

The research was particularly relevant to the current stage of Food Remedy because the project is moving from research and development towards implementation, testing and release-readiness activities. The findings can therefore support the Frontend, Backend and Database teams when preparing the application for testing and eventual deployment.

2. Research Objectives

The research had the following objectives:

- Research current Google Play requirements relevant to Android applications.
- Identify developer account and application ownership requirements.
- Investigate appropriate Google Play testing tracks.
- Identify the current target API level requirement.
- Research privacy policy and Data Safety requirements.
- Investigate requirements relevant to health-related applications.
- Research account and data deletion requirements.
- Organize the findings into a practical release checklist.
- Identify requirements that could potentially block or delay Food Remedy's release.

3. Research Approach

The research focused primarily on official Google Play Console and Android Developer documentation to ensure that the checklist was based on current platform requirements rather than general third-party advice.

The findings were grouped into four practical areas:

1. Account and Access
2. Technical Requirements
3. Privacy and Data Safety
4. Testing and Release

This structure makes the research easier for the Food Remedy team to use during implementation and release preparation.

4. Account and Access Requirements

The first area investigated was the Google Play developer account and application ownership. Google Play provides Personal and Organization developer accounts. Google states that an organization account should be used for an organization or business, and health apps are specifically included among the types of applications for which an organization account should be selected. Organization accounts require a D-U-N-S number and additional verification information. The account information must also remain accurate and verified. This includes relevant contact details and the Google payments profile associated with the developer account.

Food Remedy considerations

Before release, the project team should confirm:

- The appropriate developer account type.
- Who owns the application.
- Who has access to the Play Console.
- Whether the required organization information has been verified.
- Whether the required D-U-N-S information is available if an organization account is used.
- Whether the developer and contact information is correct.

This is important because account setup and verification are dependencies that should be completed before the final release stage.

5. Testing and Release Tracks

Google Play provides several testing tracks that allow developers to gradually test an application before production release.

Internal Testing

Internal testing is designed for early testing with a small group of trusted testers. Google does not impose the same tester requirement on internal testing that applies to the production-access requirement for certain new personal accounts.

This makes internal testing useful for Food Remedy while the development teams are still identifying bugs and integration issues.

Closed Testing

Closed testing allows the team to test the application with a controlled group of users. For personal developer accounts created after 13 November 2023, Google currently requires at least 12 testers to remain opted into the closed test continuously for 14 days before production access can be requested. Therefore, the project should confirm which type of developer account will be used before applying this requirement directly to the Food Remedy release plan.

Production

Production release makes the application available to users through Google Play. Before moving to production, the team should ensure that the application has completed the applicable testing requirements and that the required Play Console declarations and release information are complete.

Recommended Food Remedy flow

The research therefore identified the following practical release flow:

Development → Internal Testing → Closed Testing → Production

The exact testing requirements depend on the developer account and application circumstances.

6. Target API Level

The target API level was identified as an important technical release requirement. As of **31 August 2026**, new Android applications and application updates submitted to Google Play must target **Android 16 (API level 36) or higher** for standard Android applications. This means that the Food Remedy Android application needs to verify its current target SDK configuration before submission. The development team should check the Android project's `targetSdkVersion` or equivalent Gradle configuration and confirm that it satisfies the current Google Play requirement.

Checklist item

- ☐ Confirm Food Remedy target API level.
- ☐ Ensure the application targets API 36 or higher for submission from 31 August 2026.
- ☐ Test the application against the target Android version.
- ☐ Resolve compatibility problems before release.

This requirement was identified as a potential technical release blocker because an application that does not meet the applicable target API requirement may not be eligible for submission.

7. Privacy Policy and Data Safety

Privacy and data handling were another major area of investigation. Google Play requires developers to provide accurate information about how an application collects, uses and shares user data through the **Data Safety** section. This includes data handled through third-party libraries and SDKs used by the application. The information provided in Data Safety must accurately reflect the application's actual behavior. For Food Remedy, this means that the project teams should review the application's data flow across the Frontend, Backend and Database components before completing the final declaration.

For example, the team should determine:

- What user information is collected.
- What information is sent from the Android application to the API.
- What information is stored by the backend/database.
- Whether information is shared with third-party services.
- Whether third-party SDKs collect or transmit information.
- How collected information is protected.
- How long is the information retained.

Google also requires an appropriate privacy policy.

Food Remedy checklist

- ☐ Privacy policy prepared.
- ☐ Privacy policy is accessible from the application.
- ☐ Privacy policy is available through the Play Console.
- ☐ Data Safety form completed.
- ☐ Data collection documented.
- ☐ Data sharing documented.
- ☐ Third-party SDKs reviewed.
- ☐ Data Safety information matches actual implementation.

8. Account and Data Deletion

The research also investigated account deletion requirements. If an application allows users to create an account, Google Play requires users to have a way to request deletion of their account and associated data. Google requires an **in-app deletion path** as well as a web-based resource for requesting account deletion. For Food Remedy, this requirement should therefore be checked against the actual application functionality.

Checklist

- ☐ Confirm whether Food Remedy provides user accounts.
- ☐ Confirm what user information is associated with an account.
- ☐ Provide an appropriate in-app deletion process if accounts can be created.
- ☐ Provide the required web-based deletion request process.
- ☐ Define what data is deleted.
- ☐ Ensure the deletion behavior matches the privacy policy and Data Safety declaration.

This also creates a dependency between the application's Frontend, Backend and Database components because account deletion needs to be reflected across the relevant parts of the system.

9. Health-Related Application Requirements

Food Remedy also needs to consider Google Play's Health Apps requirements because the application relates to food, nutrition and potentially health-related information. Google requires developers to complete the **Health Apps declaration** in Play Console. This applies even to applications that do not provide health features; developers must declare that no health features are provided if that is the case. Google identifies **Nutrition and Weight Management** as a health-related category, including applications focused on dietary intake, meal planning and specific dietary needs.

Therefore, Food Remedy's exact functionality should be reviewed before selecting the declaration category. The team should also be careful about health-related claims. Google states that health and medical applications must not provide misleading or harmful health functionality or claims.

Food Remedy checklist

- ☐ Review Food Remedy's functionality against Google Health Apps categories.
- ☐ Complete the Health Apps declaration.
- ☐ Identify whether nutrition-related functionality applies.
- ☐ Review health-related information and claims.
- ☐ Avoid unsupported medical claims.
- ☐ Ensure privacy requirements for relevant data are addressed.

10. Application Review and Store Information

The research also identified information that needs to be prepared for Google's application review. Google requires accurate application information and metadata before submission. Developers must also provide the resources required for Google to review the application, including login information where necessary.

For Food Remedy, this may include:

- Application name.
- Application description.
- Application icon.
- Screenshots.
- Content rating.
- App access information.
- Demo accounts were required.
- Reviewer instructions were required.
- Required Play Console declarations.

If parts of Food Remedy are restricted behind authentication, the team should make sure reviewers can access the required functionality.

11. Release Requirements Categorization

The research findings were organized into the following categories.

Category	Key Requirements	Food Remedy Relevance
Account / Access	Developer account, ownership, verification, Play Console access	Confirm account ownership and access

Technical	Target API, build configuration, compatibility	Confirm API 36+ requirement
Privacy / Data Safety	Privacy policy, data collection, data sharing, SDK review	Review Food Remedy data flows
Accounts / Data	Account deletion and associated data	Relevant if user accounts are implemented
Health	Health Apps declaration, health claims	Relevant due to food/nutrition functionality
Testing	Internal and closed testing	Required for release preparation
Release	Store listing, metadata, reviewer access	Required before production submission

12. Potential Release Blockers

The following were identified as items that could potentially block or delay Food Remedy's release.

1. Incorrect target API level

The application must satisfy the current Google Play target API requirement. For standard Android applications submitted from 31 August 2026, this means API level 36 or higher.

2. Incomplete developer verification

Missing or incorrect developer account information can delay the release process. Organization accounts have additional verification requirements.

3. Incomplete testing

Where the new personal-account testing requirement applies, the required closed test must be completed before production access can be requested.

4. Incorrect Data Safety information

Data Safety declarations must accurately represent data collection and sharing, including relevant third-party SDK behavior.

5. Missing privacy policy

A suitable privacy policy must be provided and made accessible in the required locations.

6. Missing account deletion functionality

If Food Remedy allows account creation, the required account and data deletion process must be provided.

7. Incomplete Health Apps declaration

The Health Apps declaration needs to be completed accurately before release.

8. Reviewer access problems

If Food Remedy requires authentication, reviewers need the appropriate access information to review the application.

13. Practical Google Play Release Checklist

The final research output was converted into the following checklist for the Food Remedy project.

Category	Requirement / Check	Status
Account & Access	Confirm the appropriate Google Play developer account type	☐
Account & Access	Confirm Food Remedy application ownership	☐
Account & Access	Complete developer identity verification	☐
Account & Access	Complete required organization information	☐
Account & Access	Confirm D-U-N-S information if an organization account is used	☐
Account & Access	Confirm appropriate team members have Play Console access	☐
Technical	Confirm the Android target API level meets the current Google Play requirement	☐
Technical	Generate a successful release build of Food Remedy	☐
Technical	Test the application on supported Android versions	☐
Technical	Resolve critical crashes and blocking technical issues	☐

Testing	Complete internal testing	☐
Testing	Review and document internal testing results	☐
Testing	Check whether closed-testing requirements apply to the developer account	☐
Testing	Complete required closed testing if applicable	☐
Testing	Confirm required testers are available if applicable	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Prepare a valid privacy policy	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Make the privacy policy accessible from the required locations	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Complete the Google Play Data Safety form	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Document all data collected by Food Remedy	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Document on how collected data is used	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Document any data shared with third parties	☐
Privacy & Data Safety	Review third-party SDKs and services for data collection	☐
Accounts & Data	Confirm whether Food Remedy provides user accounts	☐
Accounts & Data	Implement in-app account deletion if accounts are supported	☐
Accounts & Data	Provide the required web-based account/data deletion process	☐
Accounts & Data	Define which user data is deleted when an account is deleted	☐
Accounts & Data	Ensure deletion behavior matches the privacy policy and Data Safety information	☐

Health	Determine whether Food Remedy falls under Google's Health Apps requirements	☐
Health	Complete the Health Apps declaration	☐
Health	Review of Food Remedy's nutrition/health-related functionality	☐
Health	Review of health-related claims and information	☐
Health	Remove or revise unsupported/misleading health claims	☐
Release	Complete the Google Play store listing	☐
Release	Prepare accurate application description	☐
Release	Prepare application screenshots and store assets	☐
Release	Complete content rating requirements	☐
Release	Provide reviewer access information where required	☐
Release	Provide valid demo credentials if application functionality requires login	☐
Release	Complete all required Play Console declarations	☐
Final Review	Conduct final release-readiness review before production submission	☐

14. Relevance to the Food Remedy Project

This research provides practical support to the other project teams rather than being limited to Google Play documentation.

Frontend Team

The findings provide requirements that may need to be reflected in the Android application, particularly:

- Account deletion.
- Privacy policy access.
- User disclosures.
- Application permissions.
- Testing and release configuration.

Backend Team

The Backend team should consider:

- Account and data deletion.
- Data retention.
- API data handling.
- User information transmitted through the API.
- Security of stored data.
- Any third-party services involved in the application.

Database Team

The Database team can use the findings when reviewing:

- User data storage.
- Data retention.
- Deletion requirements.
- Personal or sensitive information.
- Consistency between stored data and the application's privacy declarations.

Research Team

The Research Team can use the checklist as a release-readiness reference and continue reviewing policy changes as the project approaches deployment.

15. Outcome and Deliverables

The research produced the three main deliverables specified in the ticket:

Deliverable 1 – Google Play Release/Access Checklist

A practical checklist was developed covering account, technical, privacy, testing, health and release requirements.

Deliverable 2 – Requirements Categorization Table

The requirements were categorized into:

- Account/Access
- Technical
- Privacy/Data Safety
- Testing/Release

Additional health and account-deletion considerations were included because of their relevance to Food Remedy.

Deliverable 3 – Potential Release Blockers

A separate list of potential blockers was created, including:

- Target API requirements.
- Developer verification.
- Testing requirements.
- Data Safety.
- Privacy policy.
- Account deletion.
- Health declaration.
- Reviewer access.

16. Conclusion

The research established that Google Play release readiness involves more than simply producing a working Android build. Food Remedy needs to satisfy a combination of technical, account, testing, privacy, data, health and release requirements before production submission. The most important outcome of the ticket is the practical checklist, which converts the research into something that the project team can use during implementation and final release preparation.

The checklist can also be used across the Backend, Frontend and Database teams to identify dependencies early, particularly around data handling, account deletion, privacy, health-related functionality and application access.

Overall, RE016 provides the Food Remedy project with a structured release-readiness reference that can be revisited as the application moves closer to Google Play testing and production release.

17. References

- Meet google play's target API level requirement. (2025). Android Developers. https://developer.android.com/google/play/requirements/target-sdk?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- App testing requirements for new personal developer accounts - play console help. (2023). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/14151465?hl=en-GB>
- Verify your developer identity information - play console help. (2024). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/10841920?hl=en>

- Understanding google play's app account deletion requirements - play console help. (2024). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/13327111?hl=en>
- Provide information for the health apps declaration form - play console help. (2024). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/14738291?hl=en>
- Health content and services - play console help. (2026). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/16679511?hl=en-GB>
- Play console requirements - play console help. (2026). Google.Com. <https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/10788890?hl=en>